

BINOMIAL THEOREM

- **Binomial Expression**: An algebraic expression consisting of two terms with +ve or -ve sign between them is called as binomial expression.
- **Binomial Theorem for Positive Integral Index**: If n is a positive integer then,

$$(x + a)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r = {}^nC_0 x^n + {}^nC_1 x^{n-1} a^1 + {}^nC_2 x^{n-2} a^2 + \dots + {}^nC_n a^n$$

- The number of terms in the expansion of $(x + a)^n$ is $n + 1$.
- The sum of powers of x and a in any terms in the expansion of $(x + a)^n$ is n .
- The general term in the expansion of $(x + a)^n$ is $T_{r+1} = {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r$.
- ${}^nC_0, {}^nC_1, {}^nC_2, \dots, {}^nC_n$ are binomial coefficients in the expansion of $(x + a)^n$.
- The binomial coefficients which equidistant from the beginning and end are equal. i.e. ${}^nC_0 = {}^nC_n, {}^nC_1 = {}^nC_{n-1}, {}^nC_2 = {}^nC_{n-2}, \dots$
- In the expansion of $(x + a)^n$ r^{th} term from the end is equal to $(n - r + 2)^{\text{th}}$ term from the beginning.
- $(x - a)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n (-1)^r {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r = {}^nC_0 x^n - {}^nC_1 x^{n-1} a^1 + {}^nC_2 x^{n-2} a^2 - \dots + (-1)^n {}^nC_n a^n$
- $(x + a)^n + (x - a)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r + \sum_{r=0}^n (-1)^r {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r = 2({}^nC_0 x^n + {}^nC_2 x^{n-2} a^2 + {}^nC_4 x^{n-4} a^4 \dots)$.
- $(x + a)^n - (x - a)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r - \sum_{r=0}^n (-1)^r {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r = 2({}^nC_1 x^{n-1} a^1 + {}^nC_3 x^{n-3} a^3 + {}^nC_5 x^{n-5} a^5 \dots)$.
- The general term in the expansion of $(x - a)^n$ is $T_{r+1} = (-1)^r {}^nC_r x^{n-r} a^r$.
- The expansion of $(x + a)^n$ and $(a + x)^n$ are equal but their respective terms are not equal.
- $(1 + x)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n {}^nC_r x^r = {}^nC_0 + {}^nC_1 x^1 + {}^nC_2 x^2 + \dots + {}^nC_n x^n$
- The general term in the expansion of $(1 + x)^n$ is $T_{r+1} = {}^nC_r x^r$.
- $(1 - x)^n = \sum_{r=0}^n (-1)^r {}^nC_r x^r = {}^nC_0 - {}^nC_1 x^1 + {}^nC_2 x^2 - \dots + (-1)^n {}^nC_n x^n$
- The general term in the expansion of $(1 - x)^n$ is $T_{r+1} = (-1)^r {}^nC_r x^r$.
- The general term in the expansion of $(x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_p)^n$ is :

$$T_{r+1} = \frac{(n_1 + n_2 + \dots + n_p)!}{n_1! n_2! \dots n_p!} (x_1^{n_1} x_2^{n_2} \dots x_p^{n_p})$$

- If n is odd there will be two middle terms in the expansion of $(x + a)^n$ which are $\frac{n+1}{2}^{\text{th}}$ and $\frac{n+3}{2}^{\text{th}}$ terms.

- If n is even there will be one middle term in the expansion of $(x+a)^n$ which is $\left(\frac{n}{2}+1\right)$ th term.
- If n is odd there will be two greatest binomial coefficients in the expansion which are ${}^nC_{\frac{n-1}{2}}$ and ${}^nC_{\frac{n+1}{2}}$. Here ${}^nC_{\frac{n-1}{2}} = {}^nC_{\frac{n+1}{2}}$.
- If n is even there will be one greatest binomial coefficients in the expansion which is ${}^nC_{\frac{n}{2}}$.
- The coefficient of x^k in the expansion of $\left(ax^p + \frac{b}{x^q}\right)$ is ${}^nC_r a^{n-r} b^r$ where $r = \frac{np-k}{p+q}$.
- The term independent of x in the expansion of $\left(ax^p + \frac{b}{x^q}\right)$ is ${}^nC_r a^{n-r} b^r$ where $r = \frac{np}{p+q}$.
- **Numerically greatest term (NGT)** in the expansion of $(1+x)^n$:
 1. NGT = $(p+1)$ th terms and its value is $|T_{p+1}|$ if $\frac{(n+1)|x|}{|x|+1} = p+f$, where p is an integer and f is a proper fraction and $0 < f < 1$.
 2. NGT = $(p+1)$ th and (p) th terms and its value is $|T_{p+1}| = |T_p|$ if $\frac{(n+1)|x|}{|x|+1} = p$, where p is an integer.
- To find numerically greatest term of $(a+b)^n$ we have to represent $(a+b)^n = a^n \left(1 + \frac{b}{a}\right)^n$ and then take $x = \frac{b}{a}$ and find the term as above.
- The number of non zero terms in the expansion of $(x+a)^n + (x-a)^n$ is $\frac{n+1}{2}$ if n is odd.
- The number of non zero terms in the expansion of $(x+a)^n + (x-a)^n$ is $\frac{n}{2} + 1$ if n is even.
- The number of non zero terms in the expansion of $(x+a)^n - (x-a)^n$ is $\frac{n+1}{2}$ if n is odd.
- The number of non zero terms in the expansion of $(x+a)^n - (x-a)^n$ is $\frac{n}{2}$ if n is even.
- The number of terms in the expansion of $(x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_r)^n$ is ${}^{n+r-1}C_{r-1}$.
- The number of terms in the expansion of $(x+y+z)^n$ is $\frac{(n+1)(n+2)}{2}$.
- If $n > 2$, $n \in N$, then $(2n-1)^n + (2n)^n < (2n+1)^n$.
- If the coefficients of x^{r-1}, x^r, x^{r+1} are in A.P., then $(n-2r)^2 = n+2$.
- $(1+a)^n - 1$ is divisible by $M(a)$.
- $(1+a)^n - na - 1$ is divisible by $M(a^2)$.

- $(1+a)^n - {}^nC_2 a^2 - na - 1$ is divisible by $M(a^3)$.
- Coefficient of x^{n-1} in $(x-a_1)(x-a_2)...(x-a_n)$ is $-(a_1 + a_2 + ... + a_n)$.
- Coefficient of x^{n-1} in $(x+a_1)(x+a_2)...(x+a_n)$ is $(a_1 + a_2 + ... + a_n)$.
- Coefficient of x^{n-2} in $(x-a_1)(x-a_2)...(x-a_n)$ is $\frac{(a_1 + a_2 + ... + a_n)^2 - (a_1^2 + a_2^2 + ... + a_n^2)}{2}$.

• **Standard Result on Binomial Coefficients:**

1. $C_0 + C_1 + C_2 + ... + C_n = 2^n \Rightarrow \sum_{r=0}^n C_r = 2^n$.
2. $C_0 - C_1 + C_2 - C_3 + ... + (-1)^n C_n = 0$.
3. $C_0 + C_2 + C_4 + ... = C_1 + C_3 + C_5 + ... = 2^{n-1}$.
4. $aC_0 + (a+d)C_1 + (a+2d)C_2 + ... + (a+nd)C_n = (2a+nd)2^{n-1}$.
5. $aC_0 - (a+d)C_1 + (a+2d)C_2 - ... + (-1)^n (a+nd)C_n = 0$.
6. $C_1 + 2C_2 + 3C_3 + ... + nC_n = n2^{n-1} \Rightarrow \sum_{r=0}^n rC_r = n2^{n-1}$.
7. $C_1 - 2C_2 + 3C_3 - ... + (-1)^{n-1} nC_n = 0 \Rightarrow \sum_{r=0}^n (-1)^{r-1} rC_r = 0$.
8. $C_0 + \frac{C_1}{2} + \frac{C_2}{3} + ... + \frac{C_n}{n+1} = \frac{2^{n+1} - 1}{n+1}$.
9. $C_0 - \frac{C_1}{2} + \frac{C_2}{3} - ... + (-1)^n \frac{C_n}{n+1} = \frac{1}{n+1}$.
10. $\frac{C_0}{1} + \frac{C_2}{3} + \frac{C_4}{5} + ... = \frac{2^n - 1}{n+1}$.
11. $\frac{C_1}{2} + \frac{C_3}{4} + \frac{C_5}{6} + ... = \frac{2^n}{n+1}$.
12. $aC_0^2 + (a+d)C_1^2 + (a+2d)C_2^2 + ... + (a+nd)C_n^2 = \frac{(2a+nd)}{2} ({}^{2n}C_n)$.
13. ${}^mC_0 {}^nC_r + {}^mC_1 {}^nC_{r-1} + {}^mC_2 {}^nC_{r-2} + ... + {}^mC_r {}^nC_0 = {}^{m+n}C_r$.
14. $C_0 + (C_0 + C_1)(C_0 + C_1 + C_2) + ... + (C_0 + C_1 + C_2 + ... + C_{n-1}) = n2^{n-1}$.
15. $C_0^2 + C_1^2 + C_2^2 + ... + C_n^2 = {}^{2n}C_n = \frac{(2n)!}{(n!)^2}$.
16. $C_0^2 - C_1^2 + C_2^2 - ... + (-1)^n C_n^2 = 0$ if n is odd.
17. $C_0^2 - C_1^2 + C_2^2 - ... + (-1)^n C_n^2 = (-1)^{n/2} \times {}^nC_{n/2}$ if n is even.
18. If ${}^nC_x = {}^nC_y$, then either $x = y$ or $x + y = n$.
19. ${}^nC_r + {}^nC_{r-1} = {}^{n+1}C_r$.
20. $n {}^nC_r = (n-r+1) {}^nC_{r-1}$.

$$21. \quad \frac{{}^nC_r}{{}^nC_{r-1}} = \frac{n-r+1}{n}.$$

- If $f(x) = (a_0 + a_1x + a_2x^2 + \dots + a_mx^m)^n$, then
 1. Sum of the coefficients of $x = f(1) = (a_0 + a_1 + a_2 + \dots + a_m)^n$.
 2. Sum of Coefficients of x having even power $\frac{f(1) + f(-1)}{2}$.
 3. Sum of Coefficients of x having odd power $\frac{f(1) - f(-1)}{2}$.
- **Multinomial Theorem for a Positive Integral Index:** If $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_k$ are real numbers and $n \in N$, $(x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_k)^n = \sum_{r_1+r_2+\dots+r_k=n} \frac{n!}{r_1!r_2!\dots r_k!} x_1^{r_1} x_2^{r_2} \dots x_k^{r_k}$ where $r_1, r_2, \dots, r_k$ are all non negative integers.
 - (a) The general term in the expansion is $\frac{n!}{r_1!r_2!\dots r_k!} x_1^{r_1} x_2^{r_2} \dots x_k^{r_k}$.
 - (b) The total number of terms in the expansion = number of non-negative integral solution of $r_1 + r_2 + \dots + r_k = n$ is ${}^{n+k-1}C_n$ or ${}^{n+k-1}C_{k-1}$.
 - (c) Coefficient of $x_1^{r_1} x_2^{r_2} \dots x_k^{r_k}$ in the expansion of $(a_1x_1 + a_2x_2 + \dots + a_kx_k)^n$ is $\frac{n!}{r_1!r_2!\dots r_k!} a_1^{r_1} a_2^{r_2} \dots a_k^{r_k}$.
 - (d) Greatest coefficient in the expansion of $(x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_k)^n$ is $\frac{n!}{(q!)^{k-r} \times [(q+1)!]^r}$ where q is the quotient and r is the remainder when n is divided by k .
 - (e) Sum of all the coefficient in the expansion of $(x_1 + x_2 + \dots + x_k)^n$ is k^n , i.e. by putting each x_i as 1.
- **Important Theorem:**

If $(\sqrt{A} + B)^n = I + f$ where I and n are positive integers,

If n is odd and $0 \leq f < 1$, then $(1 + f)f = K^n$ where $A - B^2 = K > 0$ and $\sqrt{A} - B < 1$.

If n is even integer, then $(\sqrt{A} + B)^n + (\sqrt{A} - B)^n = I + f + f'$, so $f + f'$ is an integer. So $f + f' = 1 \Rightarrow f' = 1 - f$.

Hence $(I + f)(I - f) = (I + f)f' = (\sqrt{A} + B)^n (\sqrt{A} - B)^n = (A - B^2)^n = K^n$.

- **Binomial theorem for rational index:** If n is not a positive integer and $|x| < 1$ then

$$1. \quad (1+x)^n = 1 + nx + \frac{n(n-1)}{2!}x^2 + \frac{n(n-1)(n-2)}{3!}x^3 + \dots + \frac{n(n-1)(n-2)\dots(n-r+1)}{r!}x^r + \dots$$

and its general term is $\frac{n(n-1)(n-2)\dots(n-r+1)}{r!}x^r$.

$$2. (1-x)^n = 1 - nx + \frac{n(n-1)}{2!}x^2 - \frac{n(n-1)(n-2)}{3!}x^3 + \dots + (-1)^r \frac{n(n-1)(n-2)\dots(n-r+1)}{r!}x^r + \dots$$

and its general term is $(-1)^r \frac{n(n-1)(n-2)\dots(n-r+1)}{r!}x^r$.

$$3. (a+x)^n = \left[a \left(1 + \frac{x}{a} \right) \right]^n = a^n \left(1 + \frac{x}{a} \right)^n = a^n \left[1 + n \frac{x}{a} + \frac{n(n-1)}{2!} \left(\frac{x}{a} \right)^2 + \frac{n(n-1)(n-2)}{3!} \left(\frac{x}{a} \right)^3 + \dots \right]$$

and the expansion is valid when $\left| \frac{x}{a} \right| < 1 \Rightarrow |x| < |a|$ and its general term is

$$\frac{n(n-1)(n-2)\dots(n-r+1)}{r!} \left(\frac{x}{a} \right)^r a^n.$$

$$4. (1+x)^{-n} = 1 - nx + \frac{n(n+1)}{2!}x^2 - \frac{n(n+1)(n+2)}{3!}x^3 + \dots + (-1)^r \frac{n(n+1)(n+2)\dots(n+r-1)}{r!}x^r + \dots$$

and its general term is $(-1)^r \frac{n(n+1)(n+2)\dots(n+r-1)}{r!}x^r$.

$$5. (1-x)^{-n} = 1 + nx + \frac{n(n+1)}{2!}x^2 + \frac{n(n+1)(n+2)}{3!}x^3 + \dots + \frac{n(n+1)(n+2)\dots(n+r-1)}{r!}x^r + \dots$$

and its general term is $\frac{n(n+1)(n+2)\dots(n+r-1)}{r!}x^r$.

6. There are infinite number of terms in the expansion of $(1+x)^n$, where n is a rational index.

7. If x is so small that its square and higher powers may be neglected, then approximate value of $(1+x)^n = 1 + nx$.

$$8. (1-x)^{-1} = 1 + x + x^2 + x^3 + \dots + x^r + \dots$$

$$9. (1+x)^{-1} = 1 - x + x^2 - x^3 + \dots + (-1)^r x^r + \dots$$

$$10. (1-x)^{-2} = 1 + 2x + 3x^2 + 4x^3 + \dots + (r+1)x^r + \dots$$

$$11. (1+x)^{-2} = 1 - 2x + 3x^2 - 4x^3 + \dots + (-1)^r (r+1)x^r + \dots$$

$$12. (1-x)^{-3} = \frac{1 \times 2 + 2 \times 3x + 3 \times 4x^2 + 4 \times 5x^3 + \dots + (r+1)(r+2)x^r + \dots}{2}.$$

$$13. (1+x)^{-3} = \frac{1 \times 2 - 2 \times 3x + 3 \times 4x^2 - 4 \times 5x^3 + \dots + (-1)^r (r+1)(r+2)x^r + \dots}{2}.$$

$$14. (1-x)^{-\frac{p}{q}} = 1 + \frac{p}{1!} \left(\frac{x}{q} \right) + \frac{p(p+q)}{2!} \left(\frac{x}{q} \right)^2 + \dots + \frac{p(p+q)(p+2q)\dots(p+(r-1)q)}{r!} \left(\frac{x}{q} \right)^r + \dots$$

$$15. (1+x)^{-\frac{p}{q}} = 1 - \frac{p}{1!} \left(\frac{x}{q} \right) + \frac{p(p+q)}{2!} \left(\frac{x}{q} \right)^2 - \dots + (-1)^r \frac{p(p+q)(p+2q)\dots(p+(r-1)q)}{r!} \left(\frac{x}{q} \right)^r + \dots$$
